



بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

THE LIGHT OF THE QURAN

A Modern Companion to the Holy Quran Sharif

Volume I • Juz 1 • Al-Fatiha & Al-Baqarah

In the Blessed Tradition of Ahl us-Sunnah wal Jama'ah

The Opening Prayer • Faith & Disbelief • The Story of Adam (AS) • Bani Israel • Ayat ul-Kursi

Designed for the Younger Generation of Muslims by Syed Yasir Ahmad

WELCOME TO THE LIGHT OF THE QURAN

This series is your companion through all 30 Juz of the Holy Quran — one volume per journey. Each volume brings you:

Arabic verses with full transliteration and English meaning
Miracle Boxes — where modern science confirms what the Quran said 1,400 years ago
Story Boxes — the great narratives of the Prophets, brought alive
Scholarly Insights — what scholars across the centuries have said
Nasihat — spiritual lessons for your daily life right now
Bar charts, data tables, and maps — making complex ideas visual and memorable
Reflection Questions — to turn reading into transformation
Closing Du'as — so every volume ends with your heart turned to Allah

The Quran was revealed across 23 years — not as a textbook to be memorised without understanding, but as a living guide to every dimension of human experience. This series honours that purpose: to make the Quran's meanings accessible, moving, and transformative for every Muslim, regardless of background or age.

'Indeed this Quran guides to that which is most just and right.' — Al-Isra 17:9

SURAH 1 • JUZ 1

سُورَةُ الْفَاتِحَةِ

AL-FATIHA — THE OPENING

The Prayer That Opens the Quran • Recited 17 Times Every Day • The Mother of the Book

⚡ KEY FACTS AT A GLANCE

Revelation: Makki — revealed early in Makkah
Number of Ayat: 7 Verses — the shortest Surah and the most recited in the world
Special Names: Umm al-Quran (Mother of the Quran), Umm al-Kitab (Mother of the Book), As-Sab' al-Mathani (The Seven Oft-Repeated), Al-Asas (The Foundation), Ash-Shifa (The Cure)
Daily Recitation: Recited at least 17 times per day — in every raka'at of every Salah. No Salah is valid without it.
Status: The Prophet ﷺ said: 'By the One in Whose hand my soul is, nothing like it (Al-Fatiha) has been revealed in the Torah, the Gospel, the Psalms, or the Quran.' (Muslim)
Core Message: A conversation between the servant and Allah — every verse answered by Allah Himself (Hadith Qudsi, Muslim)

PART 1: AL-FATIHA — A DIALOGUE WITH ALLAH

The Hadith Qudsi That Deepens Our Understanding

Most people recite Al-Fatiha as a prayer they send up to Allah. But there is a profound Hadith Qudsi in Sahih Muslim that reveals something extraordinary: Allah responds to each verse as you recite it — making Al-Fatiha not a monologue but a live conversation between servant and Creator.

📖 SCHOLARLY INSIGHT: 'I have divided the prayer between Myself and My servant into two halves' — Hadith Qudsi

The Prophet ﷺ reported that Allah said: 'I have divided the prayer (Al-Fatiha) between Myself and My servant into two halves, and My servant shall have what he asks for. When the servant says: Al-hamdu lillahi Rabb il-alameen — Allah says: My servant has praised Me. When he says: Ar-Rahman ir-Raheem — Allah says: My servant has extolled Me. When he says: Maliki yawm id-deen — Allah says: My servant has glorified Me. When he says: Iyyaka na'budu wa iyyaka nasta'een — Allah says: This is between Me and My servant, and My servant shall have what he asks for. When he says: Ihdina as-sirat al-mustaqeem... — Allah says: This is for My servant, and My servant shall have what he asks for.' (Muslim). Understanding this, every Salah becomes a live conversation. You are not reciting into the void — you are speaking directly to Allah, and He is responding to every single verse.

Verse	Arabic	Your Words to Allah	Allah's Response
1	الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ	All praise belongs to Allah, Lord of all the worlds	'My servant has praised Me'
2	الرَّحْمَنُ الرَّحِيمُ	The Most Merciful, the Especially Merciful	'My servant has extolled Me'

Verse	Arabic	Your Words to Allah	Allah's Response
3	مَلِكِ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ	Master of the Day of Judgment	'My servant has glorified Me'
4	إِيَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ وَإِيَّاكَ نَسْتَعِينُ	You alone we worship and You alone we ask for help	'This is between Me and My servant — and My servant shall have what he asks for'
5	اهْدِنَا الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِيمَ	Guide us to the straight path	'This is for My servant — and My servant shall have what he asks for'
6	صِرَاطَ الَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ	The path of those whom You have blessed	Allah answers the du'a for guidance
7	غَيْرِ الْمَغْضُوبِ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا الضَّالِّينَ	Not of those who have earned anger, nor of those who have gone astray	Allah answers the du'a for protection

All Seven Verses of Al-Fatiha — Explored

Verse 1 — Bismillah

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

"In the name of Allah, the Most Merciful, the Especially Merciful." 1:1

Every Surah of the Quran begins with Bismillah — except At-Tawbah. It is also the prescribed opening for every significant action a Muslim undertakes: eating, drinking, writing, travelling, entering the home. The scholars explain: beginning with Allah's name means surrendering authorship of the act to Him. You are not eating by your own power — you are eating through His provision. This simple phrase, repeated dozens of times daily, is designed to dissolve the illusion of self-sufficiency.

Verse 2 — Alhamdulillah

الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ

"All praise is for Allah, Lord of all the worlds." 1:2

The Quran's first word — after Bismillah — is Hamd (praise). Not a command, not a law, not a warning. Praise. Allah begins His Book by modelling the right posture before Him: gratitude. 'Rabb al-Alameen' — Lord of ALL the worlds. Not just the world of humans, but the world of jinn, angels, animals, plants, galaxies. His lordship has no boundary. The scholars note: 'al-hamd' uses the definite article — ALL praise belongs to Allah, not some. Every genuine praise a person gives — even to another human — ultimately traces back to the qualities Allah placed in that person. All praise returns to its source.

Verse 3 — Ar-Rahman ir-Raheem

الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

"The Most Merciful, the Especially Merciful." 1:3

Two names of mercy, both from the same Arabic root R-H-M. Why repeat mercy twice? Scholars explain: Ar-Rahman is the vast, encompassing mercy that covers all creation — believers, disbelievers, animals, plants — in this world. Ar-Raheem is the specific, deep mercy reserved especially for believers in the Hereafter. The first is the mercy of the rain that falls on the just and the unjust alike. The second is the mercy of the embrace that awaits those who chose to return. Together they tell us: you are surrounded by mercy in this life, and an even more intimate mercy awaits you.

Verse 4 — Maliki yawm id-deen

مَلِكِ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ

"Master of the Day of Judgment." 1:4

After two verses of mercy comes one verse of accountability. This sequence is intentional — the Quran never lets you become complacent in mercy without awareness of justice. 'Maliki yawm id-deen' — Owner/Master of the Day of Recompense. The scholars note two readings: Maliki (Owner) and Maliki (King). Both are correct and both are beautiful. On that Day, no earthly king, no wealth, no family connection will matter. The only authority is Allah's. This verse, recited in every raka'at, is a daily reminder: your ultimate accountability is to One alone.

Verse 5 — Iyyaka na'budu

إِيَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ وَإِيَّاكَ نَسْتَعِينُ

"You alone we worship and You alone we ask for help." 1:5

💡 WISDOM: The Most Liberating Verse in the Quran

'Iyyaka na'budu wa iyyaka nasta'een' — You ALONE we worship, You ALONE we seek help from. Notice: the pronoun 'You' (Iyyaka) comes BEFORE the verb — in Arabic this creates exclusivity. It is not 'We worship You' (which could include others) but 'You exclusively we worship.' This is also the verse where the Surah shifts from speaking ABOUT Allah (verses 1-4) to speaking TO Allah (verse 5 onwards). The Salah turns from description to conversation at this moment. And 'You alone we seek help from' removes anxiety at its root: your provision, your protection, your success — all in Allah's hands, not dependent on any created being's approval.

Verse 6 — Ihdina as-sirat al-mustaqeem

اهْدِنَا الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِيمَ

"Guide us to the straight path." 1:6

This is the central du'a of the entire Quran — and the most important prayer a Muslim makes. 'Ihdina' — guide US, not 'guide me.' Even in our most personal prayer we include the whole community. The scholars note something profound: we ask for guidance DURING Salah — which is itself an act of being guided. Why ask for what you already have? Because guidance (Hidayah) is not a destination but a continuous divine gift.

The person who arrived at Islam still needs guidance to remain on the path, to go deeper, to navigate today's specific challenge. This is why it is asked 17 times a day.

Verse 7 — The Path of the Blessed, Not the Lost

صِرَاطَ الَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ غَيْرِ الْمَغْضُوبِ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا الضَّالِّينَ

"The path of those whom You have blessed — not of those who have earned anger, nor of those who have gone astray." 1:7

The straight path is defined by its travellers — those whom Allah has blessed (An'amta alayhim). The Quran identifies them in 4:69: the Prophets, the truthful (Siddiqueen), the martyrs, and the righteous. Then two negative definitions: not the path of those who earned anger (Al-Maghhdub alayhim — those who knew the truth and rejected it deliberately), and not those who went astray (Ad-Dalleen — those who lost their way through ignorance or negligence). This final verse turns the prayer outward: we are not just asking for a path, we are asking to walk with the blessed company of all who came before us on this road.

➤ NASIHAT (Spiritual Lesson):

Al-Fatiha changes when you know Allah responds to every verse — and now you know what each verse actually means. Your next Salah will be different. As you recite Verse 1: feel yourself surrendering authorship of the prayer to Allah. Verse 2: feel genuine gratitude — not just the word. Verse 3: let the two mercies settle on you. Verse 4: feel the accountability that prevents arrogance. Verse 5: feel the liberation of exclusive devotion. Verse 6: ask with genuine need, knowing you need guidance today specifically. Verse 7: feel yourself joining the caravan of the blessed. You are not alone in the prayer — and now you know every step of the conversation.



SURAH 2 • JUZ 1

سُورَةُ الْبَقَرَةِ

AL-BAQARAH — THE COW

The Longest Surah • The Foundation of Islamic Law • Ayat ul-Kursi • The Story of Adam (AS)

⚡ KEY FACTS AT A GLANCE

Revelation: Madani — the first Surah revealed in Madinah, across many years, containing the core framework of Islamic society and law

Number of Ayat: 286 Verses — the longest Surah in the Quran

Special Status: 'Recite Al-Baqarah, for holding onto it is a blessing, abandoning it is a loss, and sorcerers cannot overcome it.' (Muslim)

Contains: Ayat ul-Kursi (the greatest verse in the Quran), the last two verses (Amana ar-Rasul), the story of Adam (AS), the story of Bani Israel, the law of fasting, hajj, and marriage

Protects the Home: The Prophet ﷺ said: 'Do not turn your houses into graves — Shaytan flees from the house in which Surah Al-Baqarah is recited.' (Muslim)

Core Message: The nature of faith, hypocrisy, and disbelief; the covenant of Bani Israel; the story of humanity beginning with Adam; the laws and ethics of Islamic community life

PART 2: THE THREE TYPES OF PEOPLE — AL-BAQARAH'S OPENING

Why Al-Baqarah Begins by Describing People, Not Rules

Al-Baqarah opens by dividing all of humanity into three categories — not by nationality, race, or religion — but by their relationship to truth. The Quran's very first major Surah immediately establishes: what matters most is what your HEART does with the light of guidance.

Category	Verses	Who They Are	Their Signs	Their Outcome
The Muttaqun — Believers	2:2-5	Those who have Taqwa — God-consciousness. They accept the unseen, establish Salah, spend from what Allah gave them, believe in all revelation, and are certain of the Hereafter.	Prayer is consistent; they give without being asked; the Hereafter is as real to them as today	'They are on guidance from their Lord and it is they who are the successful'
The Kafirun — Disbelievers	2:6-7	Those who have made a deliberate, persistent choice to reject — even	Warning makes no difference to them; the seal on the heart is the	'Allah has set a seal on their hearts and on their hearing, and

Category	Verses	Who They Are	Their Signs	Their Outcome
		after seeing clear proofs. Their hearts have hardened through repeated choice.	result of their own choices	over their vision is a veil'
The Munafiqun — Hypocrites	2:8-20	Those who claim faith with their tongues while their hearts are absent — the most dangerous category because they are hidden	They say 'We believe' but do not; they mock believers privately; they spread corruption while claiming reform	'In their hearts is a disease and Allah has increased their disease'

SCHOLARLY INSIGHT: The Longest Passage on Hypocrisy in the Quran — And Why

Al-Baqarah spends 13 verses (2:8-20) describing hypocrites in vivid detail — far more than on disbelievers (2 verses). Scholars note the wisdom: open disbelief is visible and identifiable. Hypocrisy is hidden — it can live inside a community for years, causing far more damage. Allah gives detailed descriptions — the flickering candle, the man in a rainstorm, the dark path — to help believers identify the spiritual disease. More importantly: these descriptions are mirrors. Every believer should read them as a personal examination. Am I sincere in prayer or performing? Am I honest about my intention or saying one thing and meaning another? Nifaq (hypocrisy) begins not as a decision but as a drift.

PART 3: THE STORY OF ADAM (AS) — HUMANITY'S BEGINNING

وَإِذْ قَالَ رَبُّكَ لِلْمَلٰٓئِكَةِ اِنِّیْ جَاعِلٌ فِی الْاَرْضِ خَلِیْفَةً

"And when your Lord said to the angels: Indeed, I am placing a Khalifah (vicegerent) upon the earth."

2:30

📖 STORY: The First Day — When Allah Introduced Humanity to the Angels

Before Adam (AS) was created, Allah announced to the angels that He was placing a Khalifah — a vicegerent, a representative — on the earth. The angels, who had only ever seen the chaos of earlier creation, asked respectfully: 'Will You place upon it one who causes corruption and sheds blood, while we glorify Your praise and sanctify You?' (2:30). They were not objecting — they were genuinely wondering about the wisdom. Allah's answer was not an explanation but a demonstration: He taught Adam the names of all things — the capacity for language, naming, categorisation, and knowledge that no other creation possessed. Then He asked the angels to name the same things. They could not. Adam (AS) named them all. Allah said to the angels: 'Did I not tell you that I know the unseen of the heavens and the earth?' The angels immediately understood: this creature carried something they did not — and they fell in prostration before Adam (AS), by Allah's command. Every creation prostrating before humanity — except one.

🌸 PROPHET: The Six Gifts Allah Gave Adam (AS)

Scholars enumerate what made Adam (AS) unique: (1) Khalifah — divine vicegerency: the trust and authority to represent divine values on earth; (2) Ilm al-Asma — knowledge of names: the foundation of human language, science, and civilisation; (3) Ruh — the divine breath breathed into him: the source of human consciousness and spiritual capacity; (4) The prostration of angels: the honour of being the most honoured creature in creation; (5) The garden: the original home of dignity and peace; (6) The Covenant — the capacity to be held morally accountable. The Quran presents humanity as intentionally created with purpose and honour.

Iblees's Refusal — The First Sin and Its Root (2:34)

وَإِذْ قُلْنَا لِلْمَلٰٓئِكَةِ اسْجُدُوْا لِاٰدَمَ فَسَجَدُوْۤا اِلَّاۤ اِبْلِیْسَ

"And when We said to the angels: Prostrate before Adam — they prostrated, except Iblees. He refused and was arrogant, and he became of the disbelievers." 2:34

The Root of Every Sin — Iblees's Three Mistakes:

- 1. Comparison:** 'I am better than him — You created me from fire and created him from clay.' (7:12). He compared himself to Adam (AS) and judged himself superior. Pride begins with comparison.
- 2. Refusal of a divine command:** He did not ask. He did not seek understanding. He simply refused — placing his own judgment above Allah's. The scholars say: the moment you say 'I know better than what Allah has commanded' — you are walking Iblees's path.

3. Arrogance (Kibr): 'He refused and was arrogant.' Kibr — arrogance — is defined by the Prophet ﷺ as 'rejecting truth and looking down on people.' Both elements are present in Iblees's refusal. He rejected the truth of Allah's command and looked down on Adam (AS).

These three — comparison, rejection of divine command, and arrogance — remain the root causes of virtually every human sin. The cure is their opposites: gratitude (not comparison), submission (not rejection), and humility (not arrogance).

PART 4: THE STORY OF BANI ISRAEL — LESSONS IN COVENANT

Why the Quran Spends More Time on Bani Israel Than Any Other Nation

From verse 2:40 through much of the Surah, Allah addresses Bani Israel — the Children of Israel — in extraordinary detail. This is not a history lesson for its own sake. The Quran returns to Bani Israel repeatedly because their journey with divine guidance contains the most complete case study of what happens when a community receives divine favour and then fails to honour the covenant that comes with it.

Major Lessons from Bani Israel in Al-Baqarah

Remember Allah's favours	10	2:47 — 'Remember My favour upon you'
Keep the covenant	9	2:40 — 'Fulfil My covenant'
Do not exchange guidance for worldly gain	8	2:41 — 'Do not sell My signs'
Establish prayer and give Zakat	9	2:43 — the two pillars of community
Do not distort scripture	9	2:75 — they altered the words
Do not follow desire over truth	8	2:87 — 'You were arrogant'
Gratitude must follow rescue	9	2:49-52 — rescued from Pharaoh

📖 STORY: The Cow — Why the Surah Is Named After a Seemingly Small Incident

Bani Israel were commanded to slaughter a cow as a divine instruction — a test of straightforward obedience. Instead of simply obeying, they asked question after question: What kind of cow? What colour? What age? What characteristics? Each question brought a narrower answer until they had so restricted the options that finding the animal became almost impossible. Allah's comment: 'They almost did not do it.' (2:71). The lesson: excessive questioning of divine commands, driven not by sincere inquiry but by desire to delay or avoid — is itself a form of rebellion. The scholars teach: when Allah and His Messenger ﷺ command something clear, begin with obedience. Questions for genuine understanding are welcome; questions designed to avoid compliance are the pattern of Bani Israel in this story.

✦ MIRACLE: The Preservation of Ramesses II — Quran 10:92 Confirmed by Modern Archaeology

When Pharaoh drowned in the sea, the Quran promised his body would be preserved as a sign (10:92). In 1881, Pharaoh Ramesses II's mummy was discovered in perfect preservation in Thebes, Egypt — 3,000 years after his death. French scientists who examined the mummy in 1974 found sea salt crystals in the cells, consistent with drowning in salt water. This mummy — the most well-preserved royal mummy in existence — now resides in the Egyptian Museum, Cairo, as a sign for those who reflect. The Quran made this promise over 1,400 years before archaeologists found the body.

PART 5: IBRAHIM (AS) — THE FATHER OF THE PROPHETS IN JUZ 1

وَإِذِ ابْتَلَىٰ إِبْرَاهِيمَ رَبُّهُ بِكَلِمَاتٍ فَأَتَمَّهُنَّ

"And when Abraham's Lord tested him with commands, and he fulfilled them all, He said: Indeed, I will make you a leader for mankind." 2:124

Juz 1's account of Ibrahim (AS) covers the most important moment in his life: after passing every test Allah sent — the fire, the migration, the sacrifice — Ibrahim (AS) is given the title of Imam (Leader) of all humanity. The scholars note: the title came AFTER the trials, not before. This is the divine pattern. Every Prophet, every righteous person, reaches their station through the crucible of trial. The Imamah (leadership) of Ibrahim (AS) is not honorary — it is the earned result of complete submission.

Ibrahim (AS) and Ismail (AS) Build the Ka'bah — 2:127

وَإِذْ يَرْفَعُ إِبْرَاهِيمُ الْقَوَاعِدَ مِنَ الْبَيْتِ وَإِسْمَاعِيلُ

"And when Ibrahim raised the foundations of the House, and Ismail — Our Lord, accept this from us. Indeed, You are the Hearing, the Knowing." 2:127



DU'A: The Du'a of the Builder — The Most Powerful Construction Prayer

As they lifted each stone of the Ka'bah — the first House of Allah on Earth — Ibrahim (AS) and Ismail (AS) were simultaneously making du'a: 'Rabbana taqabbal minna — Our Lord, accept from us.' They did not say: 'Look at what we are building.' They said: 'Accept it from us.' This is the Islamic understanding of righteous action: the deed is yours to perform; the acceptance is Allah's to give. The builder who prays for acceptance is more beloved to Allah than the one who admires their own work. Every Muslim who makes du'a, prays Salah, fasts, gives charity, or performs any act of worship should add this du'a: Rabbana taqabbal minna — Our Lord, accept from us.

PART 6: AYAT UL-KURSI — THE GREATEST VERSE IN THE QURAN

اللَّهُ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا هُوَ الْحَيُّ الْقَيُّومُ لَا تَأْخُذُهُ سِنَّةٌ وَلَا نَوْمٌ

"Allah — there is no deity except Him, the Ever-Living, the Sustainer of all existence. Neither drowsiness overtakes Him nor sleep." 2:255

The Prophet ﷺ was asked: 'Which verse of the Quran is the greatest?' He replied without hesitation: 'Ayat ul-Kursi.' (Muslim). It is the most comprehensive description of Allah in the entire Quran — packing more divine attributes into one verse than any other.

Phrase	Arabic	Meaning	What It Reveals About Allah
Allah — no god but He	لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا هُوَ	The declaration of Tawheed — the foundation	Absolute uniqueness — nothing shares in His divinity
Al-Hayy — the Ever-Living	الْحَيُّ	Eternal life — no beginning, no end, no diminishment	His life is self-subsisting — unlike all created life that needs sustenance
Al-Qayyum — the Sustainer	الْقَيُّومُ	He sustains all of existence; nothing exists without His continuous upholding	Remove His sustaining will for one instant — all creation ceases
Neither drowsiness nor sleep	لَا تَأْخُذُهُ سِنَّةٌ وَلَا نَوْمٌ	He is never inattentive, never distracted, never off-duty	Your affairs are never unattended — He sees and manages every atom
To Him belongs what is in the heavens and earth	لَهُ مَا فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَمَا فِي الْأَرْضِ	Absolute ownership — nothing belongs to anyone else ultimately	You are a trustee, not an owner — this changes how you hold everything
His Kursi (Throne) extends over the heavens and earth	وَسِعَ كُرْسِيُّهُ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ	The scale of His authority and care is beyond imagination	The entire universe fits within the expanse of His Throne-knowledge
He feels no fatigue in preserving them	وَلَا يَؤُدُّهُ حِفْظُهُمَا	Sustaining the universe costs Him nothing	Your care and protection cost Him nothing — He gives it freely, infinitely

When to Recite Ayat ul-Kursi — The Prophetic Prescriptions:

After every obligatory Salah: The Prophet ﷺ said: 'Whoever recites Ayat ul-Kursi after every obligatory prayer — nothing will prevent him from entering Paradise except death.' (An-Nasa'i, authenticated by al-Albani)

Before sleeping: Recite it before sleeping and a guardian from Allah will be with you, and Shaytan will not come near until morning. (Bukhari)

For protection in the home: The Prophet ﷺ told Abu Hurayrah ؓ: 'Whoever recites Ayat ul-Kursi — no Shaytan will approach him until morning.' It is the shield of the household.



🌙 NASIHAT (Spiritual Lesson):

Ayat ul-Kursi after every Salah — 17 Salah per day minimum, 17 recitations of the greatest verse in the Quran. Between each Salah and the next, you are protected. This is not superstition — it is the prophetic prescription for building an invisible barrier of divine consciousness around your day. People pay for home security systems, phone insurance, and health cover. The greatest security system for the soul costs nothing: Ayat ul-Kursi, after every prayer.

PART 7: 'LA IKRAHA FID-DEEN' — NO COMPULSION IN RELIGION (2:256)

لَا إِكْرَاهَ فِي الدِّينِ قَدْ تَبَيَّنَ الرُّشْدُ مِنَ الْغَيِّ

"There is no compulsion in religion. The right path has become clearly distinct from the wrong path."

2:256

Immediately after Ayat ul-Kursi — the greatest verse of divine authority — comes the declaration that this authority does not impose itself by force. 'La ikraha fid-deen' — No compulsion in religion. Why? Because 'the right path has become clearly distinct from the wrong path.' The truth is self-evident. Compulsion is unnecessary when the evidence is clear. The human being who is given clear evidence and still chooses otherwise bears their own responsibility — and Allah will judge.

Al-Baqarah's Closing Gift — The Last Two Verses (2:285-286)

أَمَّنَ الرَّسُولُ بِمَا أُنْزِلَ إِلَيْهِ مِنْ رَبِّهِ وَالْمُؤْمِنُونَ

"The Messenger has believed in what was revealed to him from his Lord, and so have the believers. All of them have believed in Allah, His angels, His Books, and His Messengers." 2:285

لَا يُكَلِّفُ اللَّهُ نَفْسًا إِلَّا وُسْعَهَا

"Allah does not burden a soul beyond that which it can bear." 2:286

The Story Behind the Last Two Verses — A Response to the Companions' Anxiety:

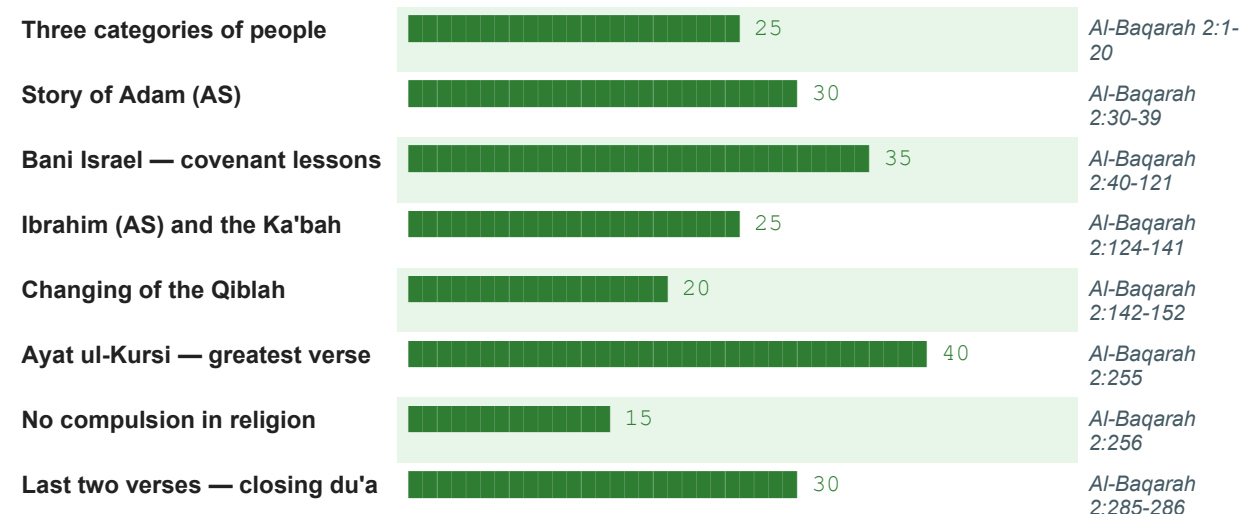
When the verse 'If you disclose what is in yourselves or conceal it, Allah will bring you to account for it' (2:284) was revealed, the Companions were deeply distressed. They came to the Prophet ﷺ saying: 'We cannot control our thoughts — are we accountable for every fleeting idea?' They were in genuine spiritual anguish. The Prophet ﷺ told them: 'Say: We hear and we obey' — expressing complete surrender. Then Allah revealed the last two verses of Al-Baqarah: confirming their faith, listing the complete statement of belief, and — with profound mercy — giving the du'a that would ease their anxiety forever.

🙏 DU'A: The Five Du'as at the End of Al-Baqarah — The Prophet's Most Beloved Closing

The last verse (2:286) contains the Companions' five du'as, which Allah then made part of the Quran — preserving their prayer forever: (1) 'Our Lord, do not take us to task if we forget or make mistakes' — Rabbana la tu'akhidhna; (2) 'Our Lord, do not burden us as You burdened those before us' — Rabbana wa la tahmil alayna; (3) 'Our Lord, do not burden us with more than we have strength to bear' — Rabbana wa la tuhammilna; (4) 'Pardon us, forgive us, and have mercy on us' — Wa'fu anna waghfir lana warhamna; (5) 'Grant us victory over the disbelieving people' — Fansurna alal-qawmil-kafirin. The Prophet ﷺ said: 'Whoever recites the last two verses of Al-Baqarah at night, they will suffice him.' (Bukhari). Suffice him from what? Scholars say: from all evil, from anxiety, from the night's dangers.

JUZ 1 — COMPLETE LESSONS SUMMARY

Major Themes of Juz 1 by Weight of Content



Golden Lesson	Surah & Verse	One-Line Summary
Al-Fatiha is a live conversation — Allah responds to every verse	Al-Fatiha — Hadith Muslim	'My servant has praised Me... and My servant shall have what he asks for'
'You alone I worship' is the most liberating declaration a human can make	Al-Fatiha 1:5	It frees you from every other form of slavery
Three types of people: believer, disbeliever, hypocrite — check which you are	Al-Baqarah 2:1-20	The most important self-examination in the Quran
Adam (AS) was given the gift of knowledge — and that knowledge honoured him above angels	Al-Baqarah 2:31-33	Human dignity is rooted in the divine trust of knowledge
Iblees's root sin: 'I am better than him' — comparison leads to arrogance	Al-Baqarah 2:34	Every sin traces back to pride; humility is the antidote
Bani Israel's failure: receiving divine favour without honouring the covenant	Al-Baqarah 2:40-121	Favour comes with responsibility — ingratitude costs everything
Ayat ul-Kursi after every Salah — the prophet said it is the path to Paradise	Al-Baqarah 2:255	Five minutes of protection for the price of 50 words
'Allah does not burden a soul beyond what it can bear'	Al-Baqarah 2:286	Every difficulty you face — you can bear it. Allah confirmed it.

Reflection Questions — Juz 1



Question	Verse	Action This Week
Do I recite Al-Fatiha in Salah knowing Allah is responding to each verse?	Al-Fatiha — all	In your next Salah: pause after each verse and feel the divine response
Which of the three categories (believer, disbeliever, hypocrite) describes my private self?	Al-Baqarah 2:1-20	Honest self-examination: is my private practice different from my public presentation?
Is there a 'I know better' moment in my life — where I am choosing my judgment over Allah's command?	Al-Baqarah 2:34	Name it. Bring it to submission. That is the reversal of Iblees's sin.
Do I recite Ayat ul-Kursi after every Salah?	Al-Baqarah 2:255	Commit to it this week — after every prayer, without exception
Have I memorised the last two verses of Al-Baqarah?	Al-Baqarah 2:285-286	If not, begin today — they take 10 minutes and the Prophet ﷺ said they 'suffice' you



رَبَّنَا تَقَبَّلْ مِنَّا إِنَّكَ أَنْتَ السَّمِيعُ الْعَلِيمُ

Rabbana taqabbal minna innaka anta as-Samee' ul-'Aleem

'Our Lord, accept from us. Indeed, You are the Hearing, the Knowing.'

— Du'a of Ibrahim (AS) and Ismail (AS) as they built the Ka'bah (Al-Baqarah 2:127)

Volume II — Juz 2 & 3: Al-Baqarah (close) & Aal-e-Imran

Charity & Riba • Fasting • The Battle of Uhud • The Family of Imran • Maryam & Isa (AS)

Compiled with love for the Ummah of the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ

In the blessed tradition of Ahl us-Sunnah wal Jama'ah

Sallallahu alayhi wa aalihi wa sahbihi wa sallam